

HTML Comments

HTML comments are notes written inside HTML source code. Browsers do not display them on the webpage.

Syntax

```
<!-- This is an HTML comment -->
```

A comment begins with `<!--` and ends with `-->`.

Basic example

```
<!DOCTYPE html>
<html lang="en">
<head>
  <meta charset="UTF-8">
  <title>HTML Comments</title>
</head>
<body>

  <!-- This is the main heading -->
  <h1>Welcome to My Website</h1>

  <!-- This paragraph describes HTML -->
  <p>HTML is used to structure webpages.</p>

</body>
</html>
```

The browser displays only:

```
Welcome to My Website
HTML is used to structure webpages.
```

The comments remain visible only in the source code.

Uses of HTML comments

1. Explaining code

Comments help developers understand the purpose of different parts of a webpage.

```
<!-- Student registration section -->
<h2>Student Registration</h2>
<p>Complete the form to register.</p>
```

2. Organizing webpage sections

```
<!-- Header starts -->
<header>
  <h1>University Website</h1>
```

```
</header>
<!-- Header ends -->

<!-- Main content starts -->
<main>
    <p>Welcome to the university portal.</p>
</main>
<!-- Main content ends -->
```

3. Temporarily hiding HTML code

Comments can temporarily prevent an element from appearing without deleting it.

```
<!--
<p>Admissions are currently closed.</p>
-->
```

The paragraph will not be displayed.

To show it again, remove the comment symbols:

```
<p>Admissions are currently closed.</p>
```

4. Leaving reminders

```
<!-- TODO: Add the registration form here -->
<!-- Update the deadline after confirmation -->
<p>Registration closes on 10 September 2026.</p>
```

5. Explaining closing tags

This can be helpful in long or complex documents.

```
<section>
    <h2>Course Information</h2>
    <p>This course covers HTML and CSS.</p>
</section>
<!-- End of course information -->
```

Single-line comment

```
<!-- This is a single-line comment -->
```

Multiline comment

A comment can cover multiple lines:

```
<!--
This section contains information
about the HTML course.
It will be updated next semester.
-->
```

Temporarily hiding multiple elements

```
<!--  
<h2>Upcoming Event</h2>  
<p>The event will be held on 15 September.</p>  
<a href="register.html">Register Now</a>  
-->
```

None of these elements will appear on the webpage.

Inline comment

A comment may also be written between elements:

```
<h1>Web Development</h1>  
  
<!-- Course introduction -->  
  
<p>This course covers HTML, CSS and JavaScript.</p>
```

Avoid placing a comment inside the opening tag:

```
<!-- Incorrect -->  
<p <!-- comment -->>Welcome</p>
```

Write it before or after the element instead:

```
<!-- Correct: introductory paragraph -->  
<p>Welcome</p>
```

Important rules

- A comment must begin with `<!--`.
- A comment must end with `-->`.
- Comments are not displayed by the browser.
- HTML comments should not be nested.
- Comments can contain multiple lines.
- Do not store passwords, API keys or confidential information in comments.
- Website visitors can view comments by opening the page source or developer tools.

Incorrect nested comment

```
<!-- Outer comment  
    <!-- Inner comment -->  
-->
```

Nested comments can cause parsing problems and should not be used.

Comments containing sensitive data

Never write:

```
<!-- Admin password: admin123 -->
```

HTML comments are hidden from the rendered page, but they are still available in the source code.

Complete example

```
<!DOCTYPE html>
<html lang="en">
<head>
  <meta charset="UTF-8">
  <meta name="viewport"
    content="width=device-width, initial-scale=1.0">
  <title>University Portal</title>
</head>
<body>

  <!-- Main page heading -->
  <h1>University Portal</h1>

  <!-- Navigation section -->
  <nav>
    <a href="index.html">Home</a>
    <a href="courses.html">Courses</a>
    <a href="contact.html">Contact</a>
  </nav>

  <!-- Main content starts -->
  <main>
    <h2>Available Courses</h2>

    <p>
      Students can enrol in HTML, CSS
      and JavaScript courses.
    </p>

    <!--
    This notice is temporarily hidden:
    <p>Admissions are closed.</p>
    -->

    <!-- TODO: Add online registration form -->
  </main>
  <!-- Main content ends -->

  <!-- Page footer -->
  <footer>
    <p>&copy; 2026 ABC University</p>
  </footer>

</body>
</html>
```